Business Analyst Interview Prep

Requirements, process mapping, UAT and documentation | Telecom / enterprise systems

Your proof points for this role (all confirmed as real)

- Mapped Invoice-to-Collection and Reactivation workflows (BPMN, AS-IS/TO-BE, 16 gaps found)
- 50 functional requirements, 23 non-functional requirements, 30 user stories with acceptance criteria
- Authored test plans and test cases; ran SIT/UAT, defect analysis, regression testing, release readiness
- Tools: Visio, Jira, Confluence, SQL, Power BI, Excel (Power Query, VBA, PivotTables)
- AI/automation projects: WhatsApp RAG support platform (4 hours to under 5 minutes first response), Queryline NL-to-SQL agent

Do not claim (not confirmed)

- IIBA, PMI or Scrum certification (you hold none)
- Financial-services experience
- Any ceremony you cannot give an example for
- Numbers you cannot source (do not estimate rupee or percentage figures)

How this file is built

- **Part 1** is the universal core. These questions appear in almost every interview, so prepare them once.
- **Part 2** is the Business Analyst module. This is the part that changes by role.
- **Part 3** is the JD tool ladder. Rebuild it for every new job description.
- The answer guides are structures to fill with your own examples, not scripts to memorise.

Part 1: Universal core (every role)

1. Tell me about yourself

They are testing: Whether you can summarise a career in under 90 seconds and link it to this role.

How to answer: Present role, then one proof point with a number, then why it fits this job. Stop there and let them ask.

Likely follow-ups: Why are you leaving / looking? / What are you proudest of?

2. Walk me through your highest-ownership project

They are testing: Real ownership versus participation. Every other question branches from this one.

How to answer: Problem, your exact role, the decisions you made, result, and what you would change. Choose the project before the interview.

Likely follow-ups: Why did you choose this approach over another? / What went wrong? / How did you measure the result?

3. Why this option and not that one?

They are testing: Whether you decided with reasons or just followed a default.

How to answer: Name the options, the criteria you used, what you chose, and the trade-off you knowingly accepted.

Likely follow-ups: What would make you change that decision? / What did it cost you?

4. Tell me about a conflict with a stakeholder or teammate

They are testing: Whether you find the real concern behind the disagreement.

How to answer: What each side wanted, what the underlying worry was, what you did, and the outcome. Keep it factual and avoid blaming.

Likely follow-ups: What if they outranked you? / What would you do differently?

5. Tell me about a failure or a mistake

They are testing: Self-awareness and whether you change your process after a mistake.

How to answer: A real, specific example, what you owned, and the process change you made afterwards.

Likely follow-ups: How did you tell stakeholders? / Has it happened again?

6. The scenario just got harder: what do you do?

They are testing: Whether you escalate honestly or just promise to push through.

How to answer: Triage by priority, check what can flex (scope, date, quality checks), then raise the real trade-off early with options.

Likely follow-ups: What if they refuse the trade-off? / What do you drop first?

7. Why this company and why this role?

They are testing: Whether you did homework and whether the fit is real.

How to answer: One specific fact about the company, one match to something you have actually done. Not generic praise.

Likely follow-ups: Where do you see yourself in 3 years? / What would you do in your first 90 days?

8. Do you have any questions for us?

They are testing: Curiosity and whether you listened during the interview.

How to answer: Ask 2 or 3: what success looks like at 90 days, the biggest current challenge, and how the team is structured around this role.

Likely follow-ups:

Part 2: Business Analyst module

R1. How do you gather requirements when stakeholders cannot say what they want?

They are testing: Elicitation method, not just 'I ask questions'.

How to answer: Interviews and workshops, observe the current process, map AS-IS, write requirements back and get written confirmation, then prioritise (for example MoSCoW).

Your story to use: Mapped the Invoice-to-Collection and Reactivation workflows with BPMN (AS-IS and TO-BE) and found 16 process gaps.

Likely follow-ups: What if two stakeholders conflict? / How do you know the requirements are complete?

R2. What is the difference between a BRD, FRS and user story? When do you use each?

They are testing: Documentation maturity.

How to answer: BRD: business goals and scope. FRS: system behaviour in detail. User story: one user-visible need with acceptance criteria. Say which your team actually used and why.

Your story to use: Wrote 50 functional requirements, 23 non-functional requirements and 30 user stories with acceptance criteria for the ERP/ISP platform.

Likely follow-ups: Write a user story with acceptance criteria for a renewal reminder. / How do you keep documents in sync after changes?

R3. Walk me through an AS-IS and TO-BE process you mapped

They are testing: Process thinking and gap finding.

How to answer: Pick one process. Describe the AS-IS flow, where it broke (delays, manual steps, handoffs), the TO-BE change and how you got sign-off.

Your story to use: Invoice-to-Collection and Reactivation workflows in Visio/BPMN with business rules and decision points.

Likely follow-ups: Which tool did you use? / How did you find the gaps? / Who signed off?

R4. Functional versus non-functional requirements: give examples

They are testing: Basic BA vocabulary used correctly.

How to answer: Functional: what the system does. Non-functional: how well (performance, security, availability, auditability). Give one example of each from your own project.

Your story to use: Your 23 non-functional requirements for the ERP platform.

Likely follow-ups: How do you test a non-functional requirement? / Which one gets missed most often?

R5. How do you prioritise when every stakeholder says theirs is urgent?

They are testing: Whether you use criteria or just yield to pressure.

How to answer: Agree criteria first (business value, risk, effort, dependency, deadline), score items together, and make the trade-off visible to everyone.

Likely follow-ups: What if a senior stakeholder overrides the ranking? / Which framework do you prefer?

R6. A change request arrives in the middle of delivery. What do you do?

They are testing: Change control and impact analysis.

How to answer: Log it, assess impact on scope, time, cost and testing, get the right approver to decide, then update requirements and traceability.

Likely follow-ups: Who approves it? / What if it breaks something already tested?

R7. How do you plan and run UAT?

They are testing: Whether you actually delivered a release.

How to answer: Entry criteria, test scenarios tied to requirements, who tests, defect severity versus priority, exit criteria and sign-off.

Your story to use: Authored test plans and test cases yourself and coordinated SIT/UAT, defect analysis, regression testing and release readiness.

Likely follow-ups: Severity versus priority: what is the difference? / UAT fails the day before go-live: what now?

R8. What is traceability and why does it matter?

They are testing: Discipline from requirement to test to release.

How to answer: Each requirement links to a design item and a test case so you can show coverage and see what a change affects.

Likely follow-ups: How did you maintain it? / What did it catch?

R9. How do you validate data or check a report is correct?

They are testing: Practical SQL and reconciliation habits.

How to answer: Row counts, totals against a trusted source, duplicates, nulls, and spot checks on edge cases. Say which SQL you actually write.

Your story to use: Reconciled payments to invoices and used validation rules and root-cause analysis for data issues across CRM, billing and payment systems.

Likely follow-ups: How do you reconcile payments to invoices? / A number looks wrong in a report: first step?

R10. What is your Agile experience?

They are testing: Honest, specific ceremony experience.

How to answer: Name only the ceremonies you can back with an example, and describe your role in each (refining stories, demos, backlog).

Your story to use: Jira and Confluence on real work, plus some Waterfall exposure. Do not claim certifications you do not hold.

Likely follow-ups: How do you write acceptance criteria? / Agile versus Waterfall: when would you choose each?

Part 3: JD tool ladder

Pick the tools and methods named in the JD (for example BPMN, Jira, UAT, SQL) and prepare each one with this ladder.

Ladder for every tool or term in the JD: (1) one-line definition, (2) where you used it for real, (3) one trade-off or limitation, (4) one thing that went wrong and how you handled it.

Terms this role usually lists: BPMN, BRD / FRS, user stories, acceptance criteria, UAT / SIT, JIRA / Confluence, SQL, API basics, gap analysis, RTM (traceability), MoSCoW

Questions to ask the interviewer (role-specific)

- How are requirements approved and who has the final say?
- What does the current process look like and where does it hurt most?
- How is UAT organised on this team?